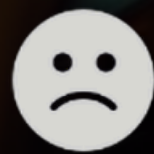


HOW MUCH CAN **Uber** SAVE EVERY YEAR BY FIXING ITS CUSTOMER SUPPORT ???



PRODUCT TEARDOWN OF
UBER'S CUSTOMER SUPPORT BY **VOJASWWIN A P**

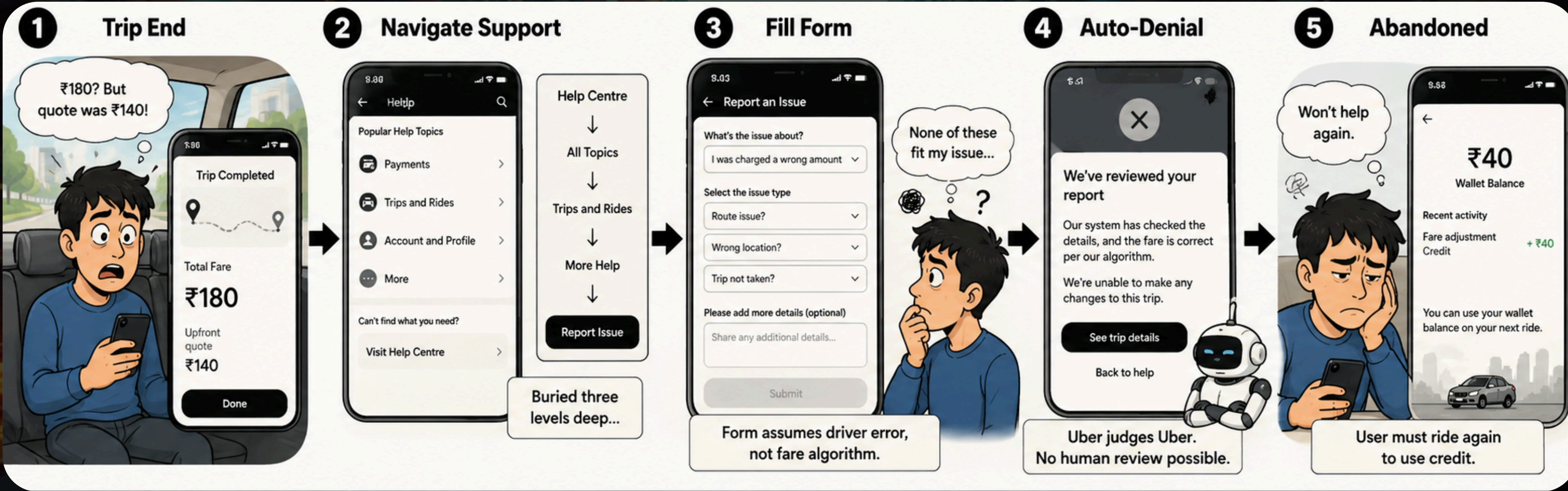


I ANALYSED 8000+ REVIEWS OF **UBER, OLA & RAPIDO** AND HERE IS WHAT THE DATA REVEALED

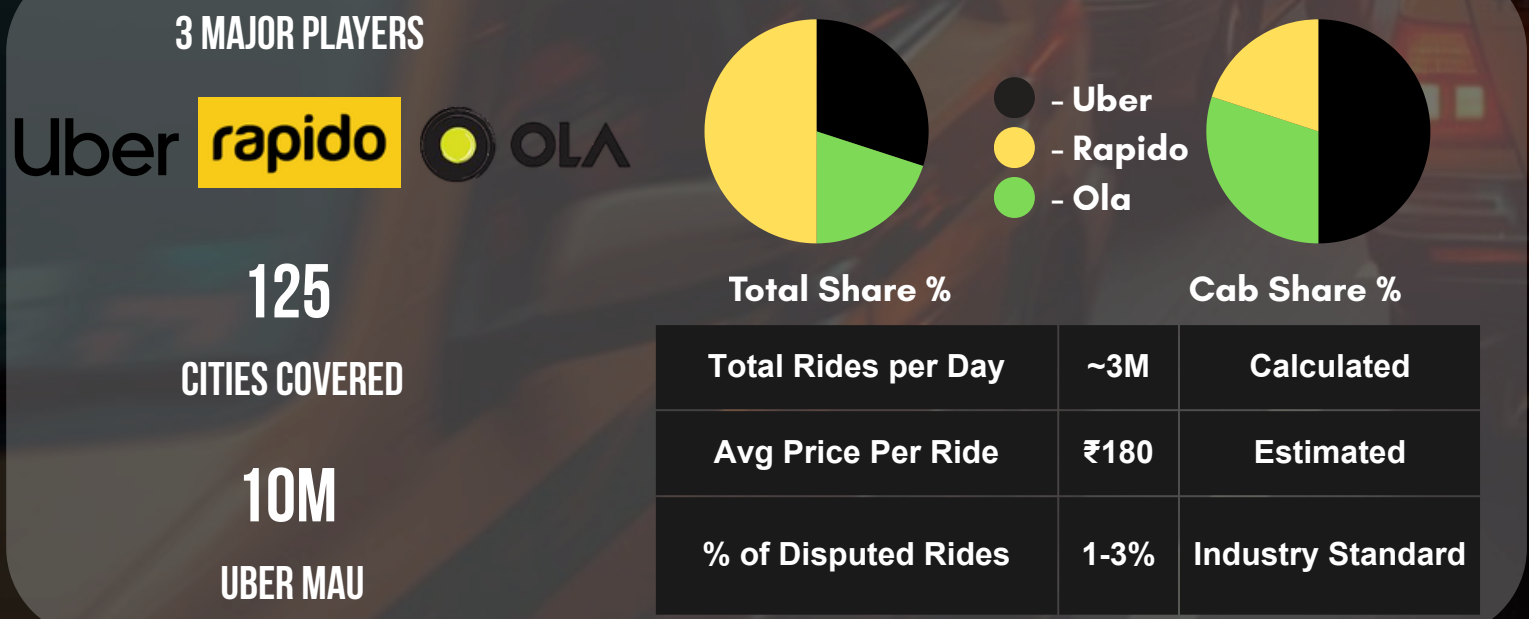
Click here for the Reviews



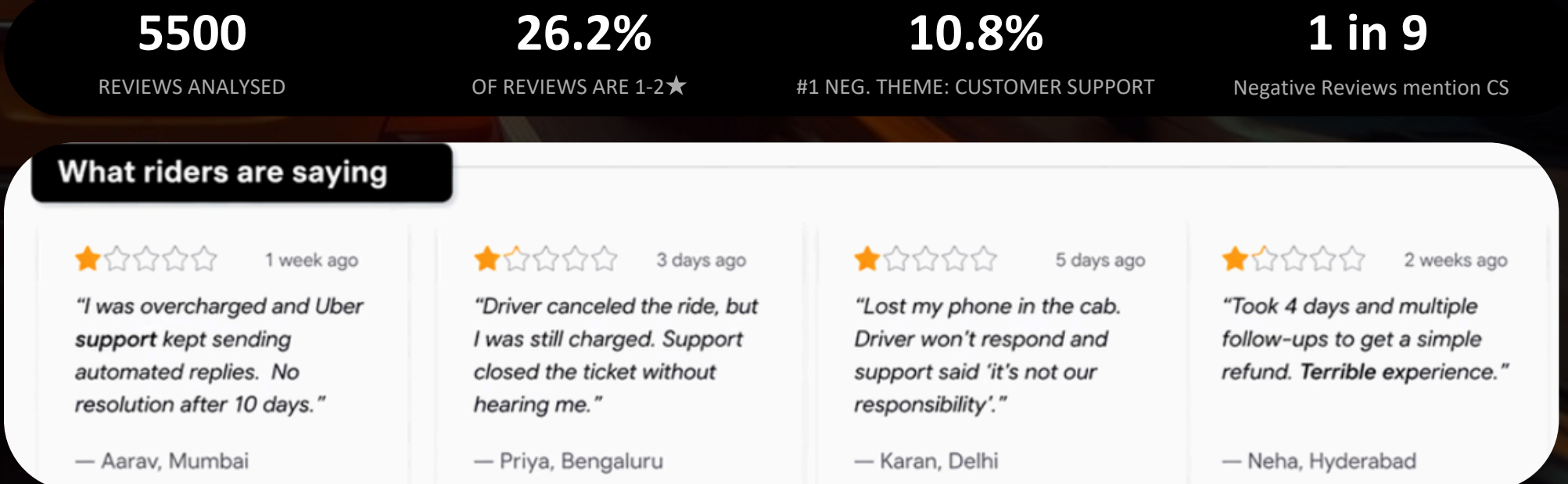
CUSTOMER SUPPORT IS BROKEN IN RIDE HAILING INDUSTRY



MARKET LANDSCAPE



UBER REVIEWS INSIGHT





BAD CUSTOMER SUPPORT LEADS TO **CHURN OF 37%**

5—9 YEAR LOYAL USERS ARE CITING SUPPORT FAILURE (NOT THE ORIGINAL INCIDENT) AS THE REASON FOR DELETING THE APP. THE TRIGGER IS FORGIVABLE; THE ABANDONED RESOLUTION IS NOT.

WHAT IS BROKEN IN CUSTOMER SUPPORT?

UBER

CS Problem Segments	% of Neg
Customer Support	10.8%
Fare Disputes <--	5.5%
Driver Behavior	4.2%
App Bugs/Login	3.1%
Surge Pricing Compliant	2.8%

FARE DISPUTES RANK #1 IN CUSTOMER SUPPORT REQUESTS WITH 4 SEGMENTS



01

DEAD END

Post-Trip Fare Inflation

Fare shown at booking ≠ fare charged at drop-off. ₹50–100 delta with no explanation. Dispute form uses wrong mental model. Auto-denied on Uber's own records.

02

UX FRICTION

Wallet-Only Refunds

Refunds land in Uber Wallet regardless of original payment method. Framed as "complimentary gesture," not restitution. One-time warning closes future recourse.

03

NO RECOURSE

Driver Cash Demands, No Recourse

Driver demands cash beyond app fare. In-app report path exists but produces no outcome. No evidence upload. Ambiguous amount entry. Framed as 'outside the Uber system.'

04

INVISIBLE

Support as a Dead End

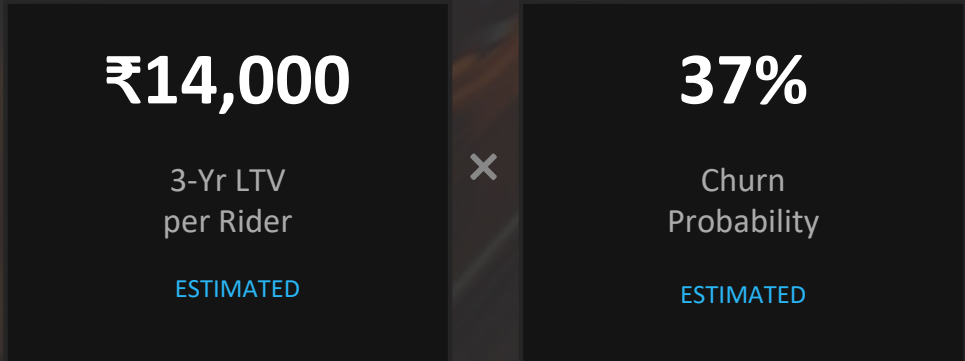
No case ID. No SLA. No push notification on resolution. AI chat auto-closes. CSAT fires only for resolved cases — denied users are invisible in satisfaction data.

UNRESOLVED FARE DISPUTES LEADS TO CHURN

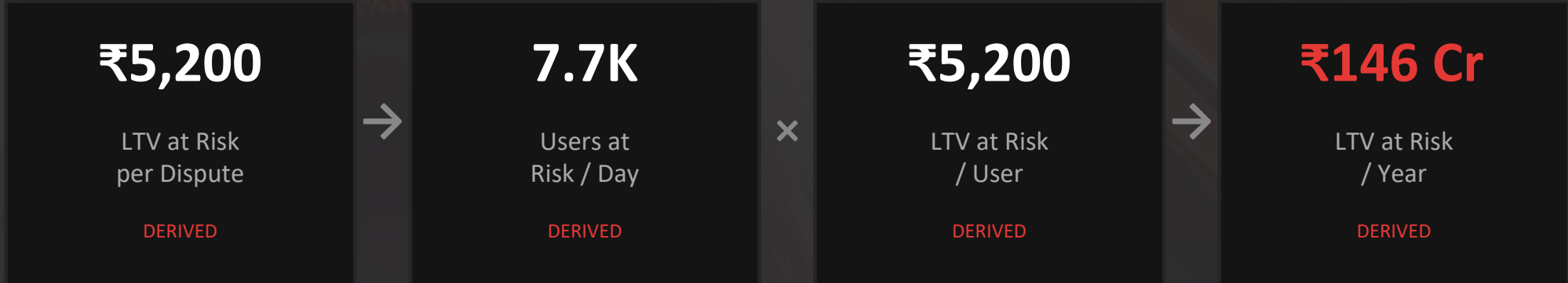
VOLUME CHAIN — HOW MANY USERS ARE AT RISK EACH DAY



PER-USER CHAIN — LTV AT RISK PER DISPUTE



IMPACT AT SCALE





UBER LOSES 146 CRORES ANNUALLY IN UNRESOLVED FARE DISPUTES

WHO FACES ISSUES IN FARE DISPUTES?

Arjun Mehta | 31 | Financial Analyst | Mumbai

Commutes 3x/week, Andheri–BKC. Uber for 4 years. Notices fare deltas on repeat, files dispute after 5th occurrence.

PAIN POINTS

- Fare shown at booking ≠ fare charged at drop-off (₹50–60 delta)
- Refund lands in Uber Wallet, not back on UPI/card
- No case ID, no SLA, no response to dispute

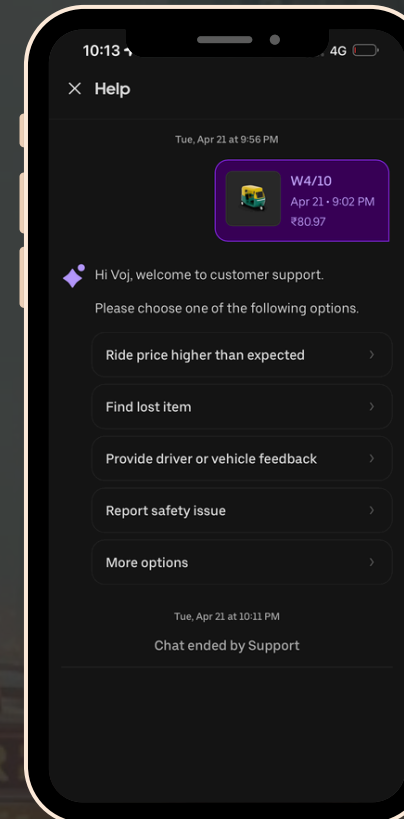
NEEDS

- Price lock at booking confirmation
- Refund to original payment method
- Case ID + 48hr SLA commitment

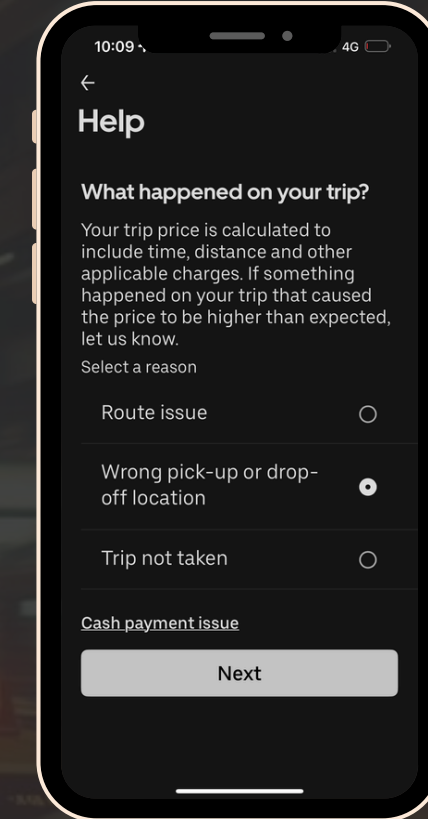
CHURN PATH: Files dispute → wallet credit → second dispute → no response → switches to Rapido



WHAT THEY FACE IN UBER TODAY??



- No proactive signal when fare deviates from quote
- Form uses wrong mental model — route issue ≠ fare delta
- Auto-denial based on Uber's own records only



- No free text cannot describe what happened
- Rigid Decision Tree makes User choose Options that they are most close to incident and not exact

Priya Nair | 37 | HR Manager | Bengaluru

1–2 trips/week for high-stakes occasions — airport, hospital. Expects zero friction. One bad experience causes silent downgrade.

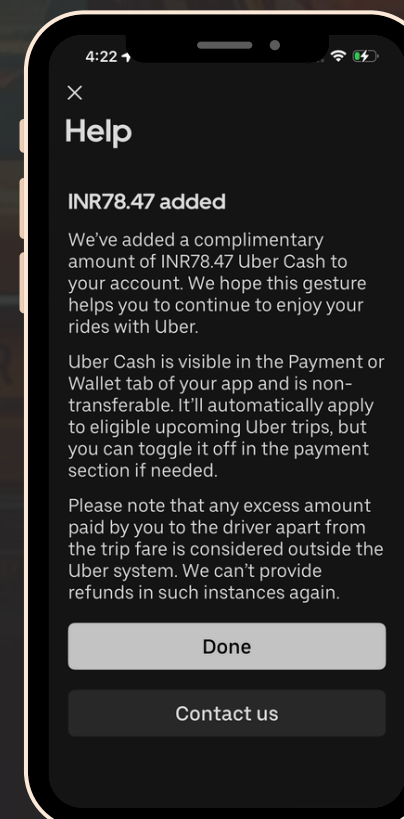
PAIN POINTS

- Single overcharge on emotionally weighted trip
- No pre-trip fare guarantee for planned journeys
- "Paid extra to driver" report leads nowhere

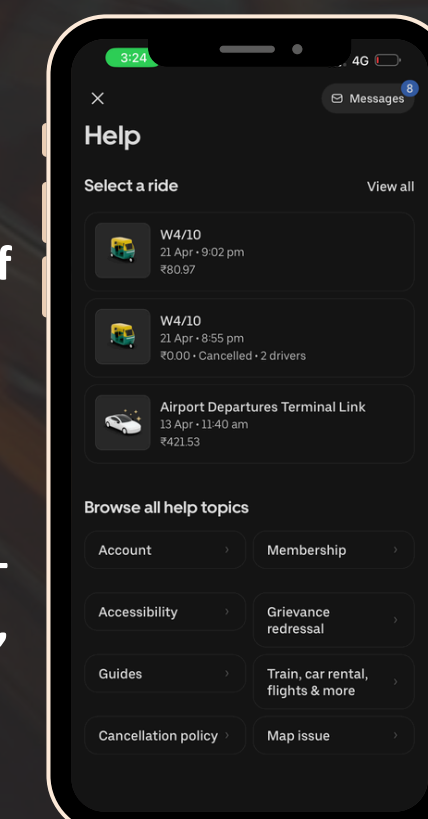
NEEDS

- Confirmed fare or ceiling before booking airport/hospital trips
- One-tap dispute flag at trip end, before payment settles
- Refund to bank/UPI, not wallet

CHURN PATH: One unresolved dispute → silent downgrade → stops using Uber for high-value trips



- Refund to Uber Wallet regardless of original payment method
- "Complimentary amount" framing — positions as charity, not restitution



- No case ID at submission, no reference for follow-up
- Inbox exists but no proactive push on status change

WHAT HAS GLOBAL LEADERS DONE TO SOLVE FOR CUSTOMER SUPPORT



AI-NATIVE RESOLUTION AT SCALE

2.3M AI-handled conversations/month. Avg resolution time dropped from 11 min → 2 min. AI has defined authority limits — decides alone up to a threshold, escalates beyond it.

UBER SHOULD BORROW:

Authority limits model: define what AI decides alone vs. what needs a human.



TWO-SIDED DISPUTE RESOLUTION

Both host and guest submit evidence before Airbnb decides. Neither party can force a resolution. The platform arbitrates with full context from both sides.

UBER SHOULD BORROW:

Driver gets 24hr response window before any resolution is issued.



PROACTIVE FARE TRANSPARENCY

User confirmation required before charging a fare that deviates from estimate. Push/SMS alert if fare exceeds estimate by >10%. Resolution SLA shown to user in-app.

UBER SHOULD BORROW:

Alert fires BEFORE payment settles — not after. Turns dispute into a conversation.



PUBLISHED SLA + AI ANOMALY DETECTION

24–48hr dispute resolution SLA published in-app. Proactive AI-driven fare anomaly detection flags suspicious fare changes before user has to complain.

UBER SHOULD BORROW:

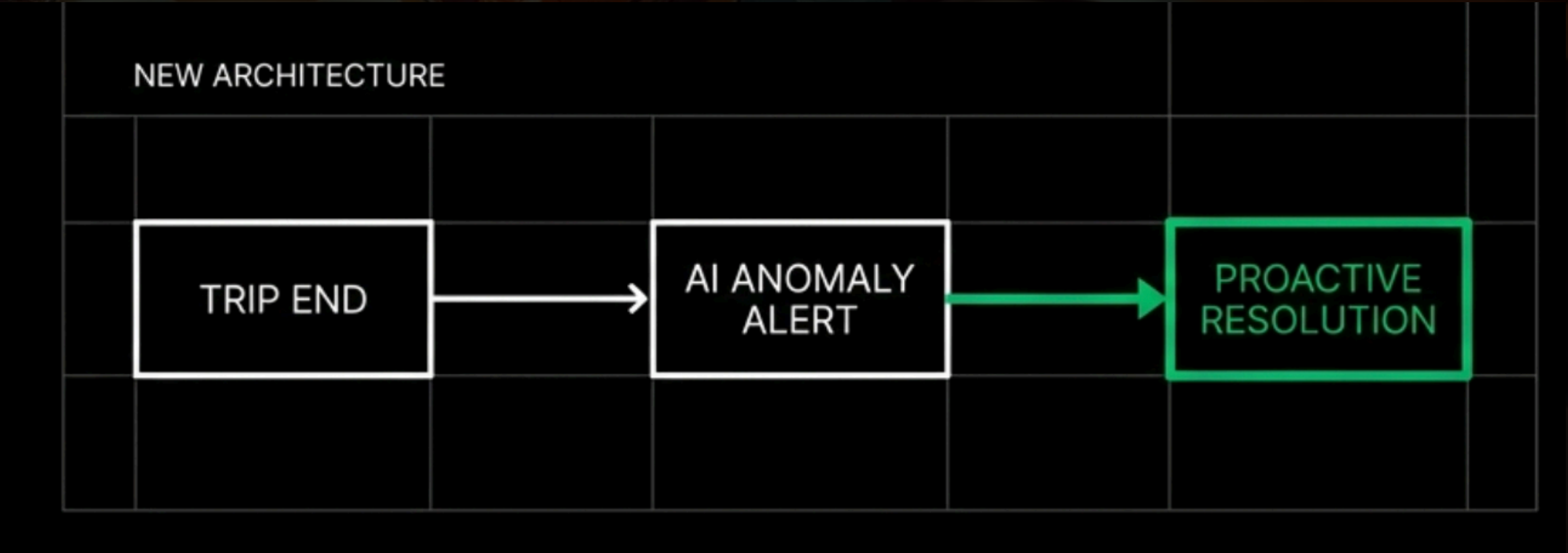
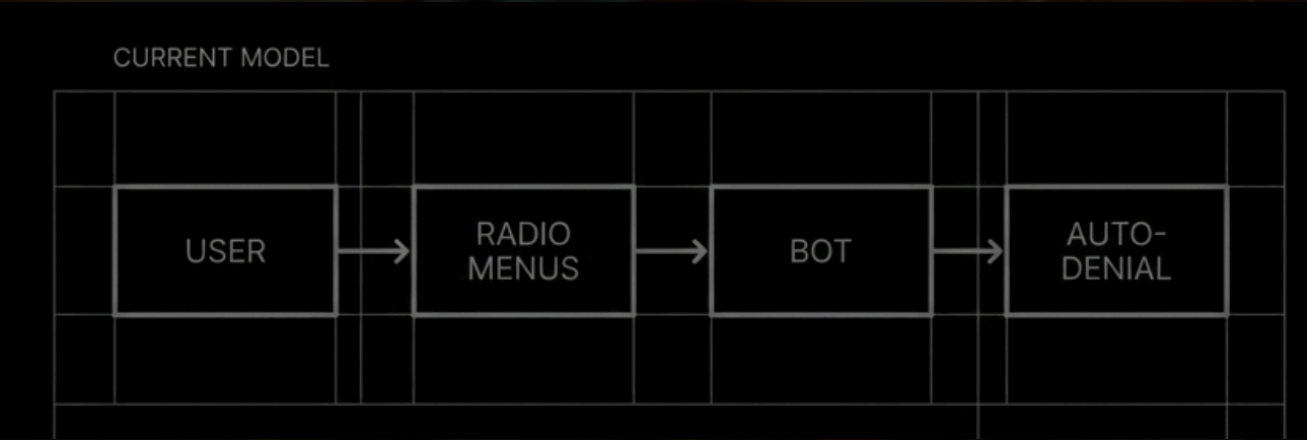
Proactive AI audit at trip-end: catch the overcharge before the rider does.

HYPOTHESIS

Uber India's payment dispute flow is architected as a classification engine — not a resolution engine. It forces users to navigate a rigid decision tree so the system can categorize and deny, not understand and resolve. Every friction in the journey is a symptom of that architecture.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

Swap the rigid flow for an LLM chat interface, add trip-end error checks, and use a confidence score to auto-resolve or escalate. Simple policy tweaks tie it together for a clearer, faster experience.



FEATURES DEEP DIVE · 1 OF 2

FM 01 · POST-TRIP FARE INFLATION

FRICTIONS

- No proactive signal when fare deviates from quote
- Form uses wrong mental model — route issue ≠ fare delta
- Auto-denial based on Uber's own records only
- No explanation of how fare was calculated
- No appeal path — 'Done' is the only CTA after denial

SOLUTION

- Trip-end anomaly detection — alert fires before payment settles
- NL input replaces radio buttons; AI classifies from description
- Multi-signal verification: GPS + surge log + driver history + booking delta
- Fare explainer: base fare + surge % (activated HH:MM) + route delta
- Confidence threshold — auto-denial retired; escalate or resolve

Key AI: Anomaly detection + LLM classifier + Confidence scorer

FM 02 · WALLET-ONLY REFUNDS

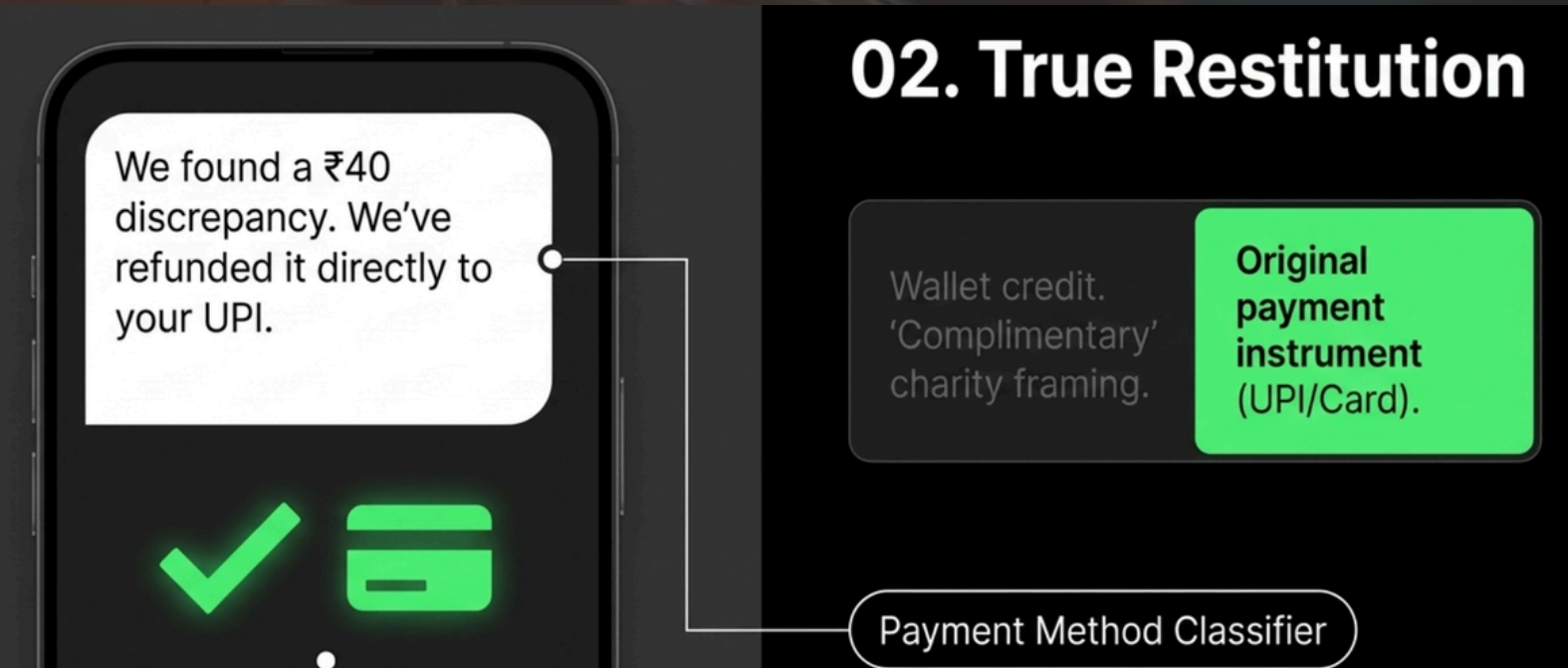
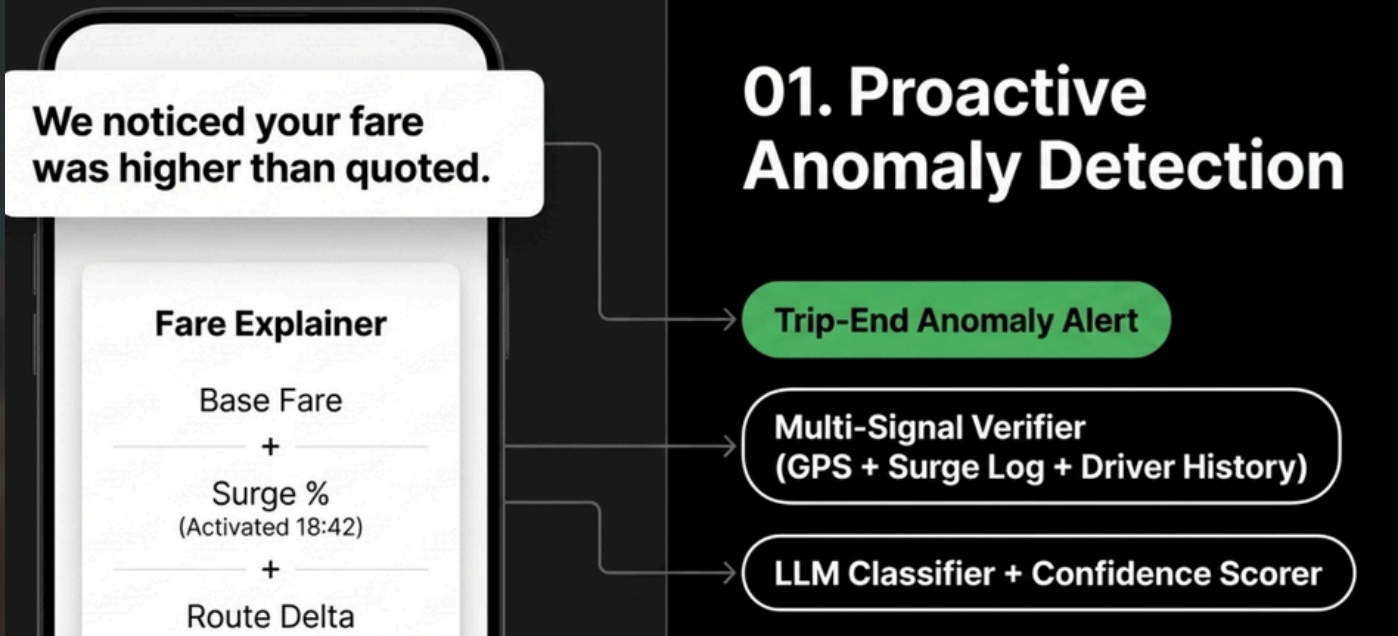
FRICTIONS

- Refund to Uber Wallet regardless of original payment method
- "Complimentary amount" framing — positions as charity, not restitution
- One-time warning pre-empts all future recourse after first resolution
- Cash dispute value requires taking another Uber ride to recover

SOLUTION

- Payment method classifier — routes refund to original instrument (UPI→UPI, card→card)
- Resolution LLM: "We found a ₹X discrepancy. We've refunded ₹X to your UPI/card"
- One-time warning removed; replaced by driver pattern detection model
- Cash disputes credited to UPI (not wallet) up to ₹200 ceiling

Note: FM2 is primarily a policy + engineering fix. AI enables it — it doesn't define it.



FEATURES DEEP DIVE · 2 OF 2

FM 03 · DRIVER CASH DEMANDS

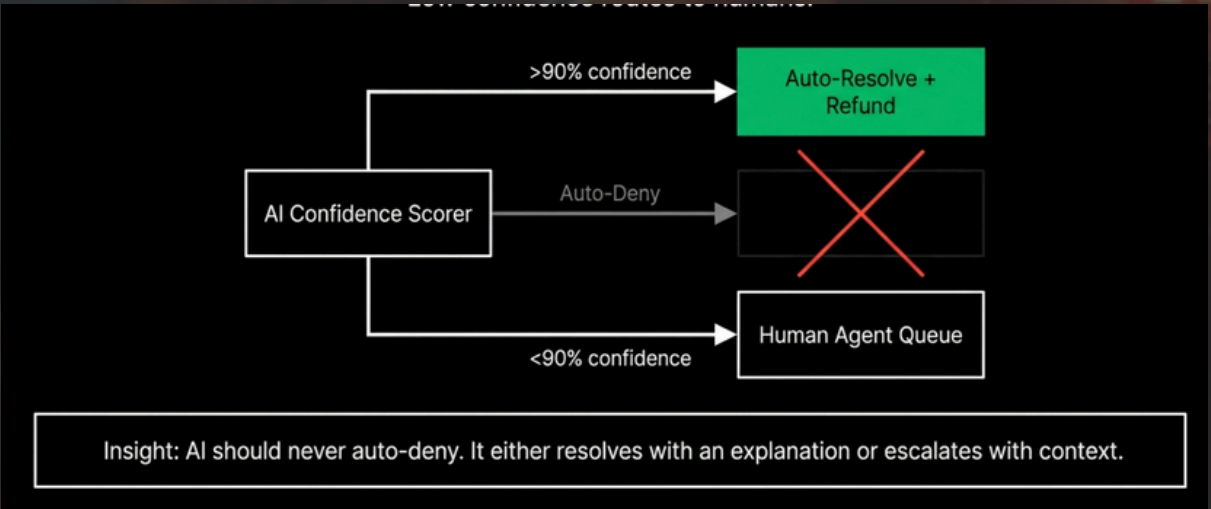
FRICTIONS

- No photo/evidence upload in the dispute flow
- No free text — cannot describe what happened
- Amount entry UX ambiguous (delta vs. total paid)
- No driver accountability signal shown to user
- One-time refund cap pre-denies all future similar claims
- "Outside the Uber system" framing within a functional flow

SOLUTION

- NL entry — AI extracts amounts, context, dispute type from description
- Route verifier — GPS cross-referenced with toll DB (no toll road = flagged)
- Driver pattern model — 3+ incidents in 30 days triggers driver review
- Two-sided input (Airbnb/Gojek model) — amounts >₹150: driver gets 24hr window
- Policy: 'outside the system' copy removed; cash disputes formally inside process

Key AI: LLM extraction + OCR verifier + Route cross-reference + Driver pattern model



FM 04 · SUPPORT AS A DEAD END

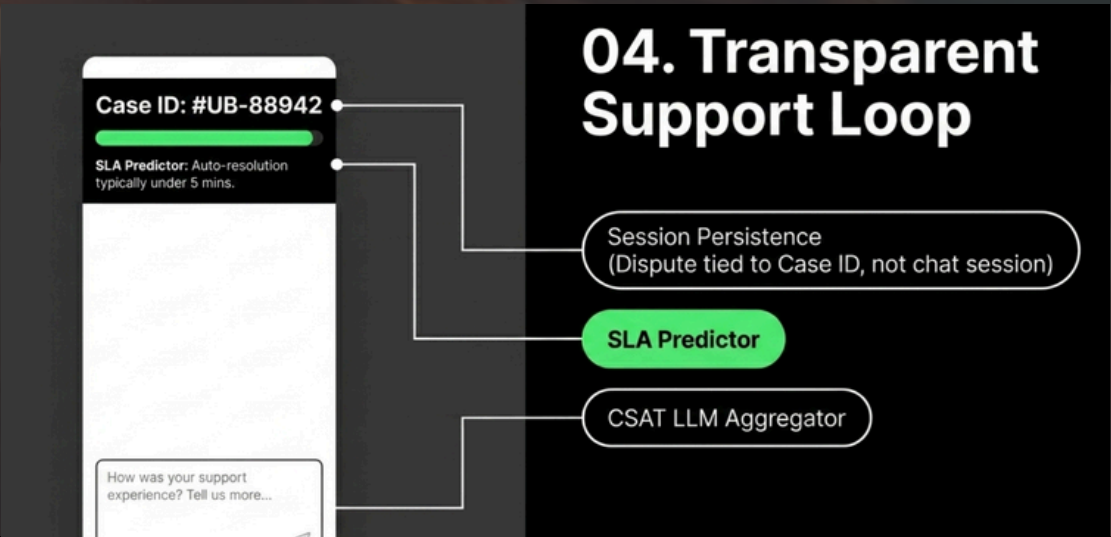
FRICTIONS (8 identified)

- No case ID at submission — no reference for follow-up
- No SLA communicated at any point in the flow
- Inbox exists but no proactive push on status change
- Auto-denial with no appeal path or confidence check
- Session auto-timeout kills all dispute context
- CSAT captures emoji score only — no free text; denied users excluded

SOLUTION

- Case ID at submission — shown in-app + sent to inbox immediately
- SLA predictor — "auto-resolution typically under 5 minutes"
- Push notification fires on every status change (not passive inbox)
- Confidence scorer: auto-denial retired — only auto-resolve or escalate
- Session persistence — dispute tied to case ID, not chat session
- CSAT redesigned — free text, mandatory for ALL outcomes including denials

Key AI: SLA predictor + Confidence scorer + Session persistence + CSAT LLM aggregator



PRIORITIZATION

SPRINT 0

Policy Fixes · Days

- Refund to original payment method
- Remove 'complimentary' framing from copy
- Remove one-time refund warning
- Remove 'outside the system' copy
- Case ID generated at submission

SPRINT 1

Engineering · Weeks

- Fare breakdown receipt at trip end
- NL dispute entry (replaces decision tree)
- Photo / evidence upload
- SLA display at case intake
- Push notification on status change

SPRINT 2

AI Layer · Months

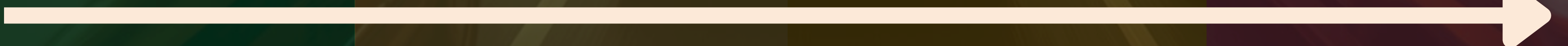
- Trip-end anomaly detection model
- LLM classifier + NL extraction
- Multi-signal verification engine
- Confidence scorer + human routing
- Driver pattern model

SPRINT 3

Closed Loop

- CSAT with free text for all outcomes
- LLM CSAT aggregator → product signals
- Driver deactivation workflow trigger

ORDER OF EXECUTION



SUCCESS METRICS, RISKS & MITIGATIONS

NORTH STAR METRIC

Payment Dispute Resolution Rate within SLA

Baseline: ~0% (no SLA, no resolution tracking) Target: ≥70% of disputes resolved within SLA in 90 days post-launch

SECONDARY METRICS

Dispute-to-churn rate → from ~37% to <20%
Time-to-resolution → auto <5 min; ≥80% SLA compliance
Refund-to-original-method rate → 100% post Sprint 1
Human escalation rate → <30% within 6 months
CSAT (dispute flow) → target ≥3.8/5 (baseline: unmeasured)

GUARDRAIL METRICS — Must Not Break

Driver false-positive rate → <5%
Fraud rate on auto-resolved cases → <0.5%
LTV delta (dispute cohort) → must trend up vs baseline in 90 days
Support ticket volume → must not spike >15% post-launch

Risk	Mitigations
Driver bias (AI acts only on user's word)	24hr driver response window + multi-signal verification for >₹150
Fraud amplification via NL input	Behavioral layer: velocity, device fingerprint, claim-per-trip ratio
Dispute inflation from proactive alert	Alert scoped to GPS-confirmed route deviation — NOT surge pricing
LLM error rate at scale	Confidence threshold; below threshold → human queue; no auto-deny
Cash refund cost model	₹200 ceiling; driver deduction only on 3+ incidents pattern
Driver has no voice	Driver notification + 24hr appeal window post-resolution